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GOOD MORNING FINANCE

India's Premium AI-Powered Daily Financial Briefing

Geopolitics · Markets · Banking · Commodities · Startups · Investor Insights

SENSEX	NIFTY 50	BANK NIFTY	USD/INR	BRENT	GOLD (INT'L)
74,068	22,958	~53,200	93.76	$94.75	$4,600
+1.89%	+1.98%	+2.1%	-0.15%	-6.2%	+2.0%

■■ **MARKET HOLIDAY ALERT: NSE & BSE CLOSED TOMORROW — Thursday, March 26 (Ram Navami). Plan positions accordingly.**

■ GLOBAL MARKET OVERVIEW

THE DOMINANT MACRO THEME — The US-Iran war, now in its fourth week, continues to be the single biggest driver of global asset prices. A possible peace plan sent by Washington to Tehran has triggered a sharp but fragile relief rally across global equities and commodities.

■■ UNITED STATES

Dow Jones (Tue Close)	46,124 ▼ 84 pts (–0.18%) — gave back Monday's massive 631-pt gain
S&P 500 (Tue Close)	6,556 ▼ –0.37% — crude re-rising above $100 eroded optimism
Nasdaq Composite	21,762 ▼ –0.84% — software ETF (IGV) down 23% YTD; AI disruption fears persist
Dow Futures (Wed Pre)	+318 pts (+0.7%) — bouncing on US peace plan sent to Iran
10-Yr Treasury Yield	4.42% — spiked 8 bps after weak auction; 2-yr at 3.94%
VIX (Fear Gauge)	~29.5 — briefly topped 30 for first time since March 9; elevated but easing
Fed Stance	Hold at 3.50–3.75%. Rate hike odds rising due to oil-driven inflation. Cuts pushed to Sept 2026 at earliest.
Key Corporate Note	Oracle: Citizens bank maintains OUTPERFORM, $285 target (+85% upside). OCI revenue $18B FY2026.
Merger Watch	Estée Lauder + Puig (Spain) in merger talks — would unite MAC, Clinique, Charlotte Tilbury brands.

■ EUROPE

Stoxx 600 (Mon)	Rose 0.6% — initial surge of 2.3% faded as IDF continued Tehran strikes
Germany DAX	Closed +1.2% Monday (had surged 3.5% intraday on ceasefire hope)
UK FTSE Outlook	GBP/USD near 1.33; energy-heavy FTSE benefiting from crude gyrations
ECB Posture	Hawkish — mirroring Fed; oil shock delaying any rate pivot

■ ASIA

Hong Kong Hang Seng	+2.8% to 25,063 on Tuesday — Iran talk optimism
South Korea KOSPI	+2.7% to 5,553 — tech stocks leading
Shanghai Composite	+1.8% to 3,881 — domestic consumption data supportive
Australia ASX 200	+0.2% to 8,379 — muted; commodity sector mixed
Japan Nikkei	Cautiously up; JPY strengthening slightly as risk-off fades
Asia Outlook Wed	GIFT Nifty +230 pts pre-open; Asian bourses likely to open green on US peace plan news

■ IMF / GLOBAL MACRO PULSE

■ Global GDP growth revised down 0.4% by IMF due to Middle East escalation and oil shock. ■ US stock market wiped out ~$2.7 trillion in market cap during March 2026 so far. ■ Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif has offered Islamabad as a venue for US-Iran peace talks — a geopolitically significant development. ■ Pakistan hosting the talks would be the first formal multilateral peace framework.

■■ INDIAN MARKET OVERVIEW

YESTERDAY'S SESSION RECAP (Mar 24): After crashing 1,800+ points on March 23 (Nifty below 22,600), the market staged a powerful 2% recovery on Tuesday as Iran de-escalation hopes lit a broad-based buying frenzy. Today's session opens with strong global tailwinds.

Index	Close (Tue)	Change	Key Level
SENSEX	74,068	**+1,520 pts (+1.89%)**	Resistance: 75,500
NIFTY 50	22,958	**+423 pts (+1.98%)**	Resistance: 23,057 / 23,400
BANK NIFTY	~53,200	**+2.1% est.**	Break above 53,500 → 56,000
NIFTY MIDCAP 100	+2.0%	**Outperformed**	Retail confidence returning
NIFTY SMALLCAP 100	+1.6%	**Underperformed large caps**	Support: 22,400
INDIA VIX	~18.5	**-6.82% ↓ Fear easing**	Healthy below 20
GIFT NIFTY (Pre-open)	~23,188	**+230 pts vs Tue close**	Watch for gap-up sustain

■ SECTOR PERFORMANCE SNAPSHOT

Sector	Move	Signal	Key Driver
Financials / Banking	**+2.5%**	**OUTPERFORM**	Top Nifty gainer; Bajaj Finance +4.85%
Infrastructure / Capital Goods	**+2.3%**	**OUTPERFORM**	L&T; surged +5.25%; Govt capex narrative intact
Consumer / FMCG	**+2.1%**	**IN-LINE**	Eternal (Zomato parent) +5.79%; demand optimism
Auto	**+1.8%**	**IN-LINE**	Supported by crude fall; Maruti, M&M positive
Oil & Gas / OMCs	**+1.5%**	**WATCH**	Crude falling = margin relief for IOC, BPCL, HPCL
IT / Technology	**+1.2%**	**IN-LINE**	Global tech selloff weighing; rupee depreciation a partial offset
Metals	**+1.0%**	**IN-LINE**	Copper +3% globally; domestic metals followed
Pharma / Healthcare	**-0.3%**	**UNDERPERFORM**	Sector-specific weakness; earnings concerns
Realty	**+2.0%**	**OUTPERFORM**	Rate-cut hope, demand resilience

■ FII / DII ACTIVITY

FII (Mar 2026 MTD)	Net SELLERS — ~■1 lakh crore outflows in ~15 sessions. Driven by US-Iran war risk, dollar strengthening, oil shock.
DII (Mar 2026 MTD)	Strong NET BUYERS — SIPs and domestic MF inflows absorbing FII pressure; preventing deeper market crash.
FPI Net (Full March)	~$11 billion pulled from equities AND bonds — heaviest since Oct 2024.
Impact Assessment	FII selling = structural headwind. DII buying = support floor. Net effect: market in a tug-of-war. Improvement likely if crude falls below $90.
F&O; Note	FIIs show mixed-to-negative derivative positioning. PCR below 1 indicates cautious sentiment but not extreme fear.

■ BANKING & FINANCIAL SECTOR

■■ RBI & REGULATORY

RBI Policy Stance	Accommodative-leaning; next policy meeting in April. Market expects a 25 bps cut if crude stabilises below $90 and CPI cools.
SEBI Disclosures	SEBI board approved major changes to disclosure rules governing Chairperson, WTMs, and senior officials — governance tightening.
RBI Fintech Action	Penalty imposed on Cashfree Payments for non-compliance with Payment Aggregator guidelines. Regulatory scrutiny on fintechs intensifying.
STT Hike (Apr 1)	Higher STT on F&O options kicks in April 1. Analysts flagging potential volume drop in options; broking revenue impact being assessed.
Rupee Watch	RBI intervention likely if USD/INR breaches 94.50. Briefly touched a record 93.98 on Monday; currently stabilising near 93.76.

■ MAJOR BANK NEWS

HDFC Bank	External law firms engaged to investigate the resignation of Chairman Atanu Chakraborty + removal of 3 senior staff. Governance clarity expected soon. Key stock to watch on any statement.
Kotak Mahindra Bank	In DISCUSSIONS to acquire Deutsche Bank India's retail banking business — a significant consolidation play. If confirmed, this would be a major private banking M&A event of 2026.
SBI	PSU banking stalwart showing resilience; DII buying concentrated in SBI. Credit growth tracking 13–14% YoY.
Bank Nifty	Outperformed broader market (+2.1%); range 52,000–53,500. A clean break above 53,500 opens 56,000 as the next target.
Bajaj Finance	+4.85% on Tuesday — among top Nifty gainers. Consumer credit demand narrative intact despite macro headwinds.
Jio Financial Svcs	Tracking parent RIL; digital finance ambitions remain long-term structural story.

■ NBFC / FINTECH DEVELOPMENTS

Moneyview IPO	Filed DRHP with SEBI for IPO — Fresh Issue ■1,500 Cr. Revenue run-rate at ■2,400 Cr. Fintech IPO pipeline building up.
Razorpay × Sarvam AI	Partnership to enable voice-first conversational commerce in payments — India's first major AI-native payments integration.
Metafin	Raised $10M in debt from Lendable for solar financing — green fintech capital flows active despite geopolitical uncertainty.
RBI on Fintechs	Post-Cashfree penalty, the central bank signals deeper compliance audits. Fintech founders and CFOs on alert.
Buy Now Pay Later	BNPL growth moderated; RBI's tighter PA guidelines forcing platforms to rebuild underwriting models.

■ STOCKS TO WATCH TODAY

*Curated for **March 25, 2026** based on events, technicals, and global cues. Not investment advice — always use your own judgment.*

Stock	Signal	Why Watch Today
HDFC Bank	**WATCH**	Governance probe by external law firms — clarity event. Any positive statement = bullish catalyst. One of the most liquid large-caps.
L&T;	**BUY**	Top Sensex gainer Tue (+5.25%). Infra order book robust. Capex cycle intact. Government spending narrative strong.
Bajaj Finance	**BUY**	+4.85% Tuesday. NBFC momentum play. Consumer credit demand resilient. Technical breakout from consolidation zone.
BPCL / IOC / HPCL	**WATCH+**	Crude at $94.75 (▼ from $115 highs). Every $5 drop in Brent = direct margin expansion for OMCs. Best crude-fall proxy in India.

Kotak Mahindra Bk	WATCH	Deutsche Bank India retail acquisition talks. If confirmed, potential re-rating event. Monitor for official statement.
Eternal (Zomato)	WATCH+	+5.79% Tuesday. Consumer discretionary proxy. Quick commerce growth story intact.
Reliance Industries	BUY	Global refining margin recovery + Jio Digital + crude stabilisation. Heavy institutional buying noted Tuesday.
Ecolab (US / ADR)	WATCH	JPMorgan upgraded to Overweight, $295 target. CoolIT acquisition adds data-centre cooling growth vector.
Coal India	WATCH	Plans stake sales in subsidiaries — value unlocking potential for PSU investors. Dividend yield attractive.
SBI Card	WATCH	Financial services sector outperforming. Credit card spend data shows resilience. Broker upgrade expected.

■ COMMODITIES & CURRENCY

BRENT CRUDE	GOLD (SPOT)	USD/INR	SILVER (SPOT)
$94.75/bbl	**$4,600/oz**	**■93.76**	**$74/oz**
▲ –6.2% (ceasefire hope)	▲ +2.0% (safe-haven bid)	▲ –0.15% (rupee recovering)	▲ +4.0% (industrial + safe-haven)

■■ CRUDE OIL — DETAILED

Brent (Current)	$94.75/bbl — fell from $115 (Mar 20 high) as ceasefire signals emerged
WTI Crude	~$88/bbl — US domestic benchmark also easing
Strait of Hormuz	STILL EFFECTIVELY CLOSED by Iran. 20% of global oil supply at risk. Any re-escalation = instant $10+ spike.
India Import Bill	Every $10 fall in Brent saves India ~$12–15 bn/year in forex. CAD improves 0.3–0.5% of GDP per $10 drop.
OMC Margins	BPCL, IOC, HPCL seeing relief. Retail fuel prices (Petrol: ■103.54, Diesel: ■90.03) unlikely to change yet — election-sensitive pricing.
Outlook	S&P Global forecasts: Brent averages $90 in March, declining toward $60 by year-end IF ceasefire holds. Highly contingent on Iran talks.
India Inflation	CPI relief expected if crude stays below $90. RBI rate cut window opens Q3 2026. Every $5 crude drop = ~10–15 bps CPI relief.

■ GOLD — DETAILED

International Price	$4,600/oz (spot, +2.0%) — rebounding sharply after crashing 25% from March peak
India 24K Gold	■14,291/gram | ■1,42,910/10g | ■1.35 lakh/10g in Delhi
India 22K Gold	■13,100/gram | ■2,35,000/kg (Silver)
Why Rising Today	US peace plan to Iran + crude falling = financial conditions easing = gold recovering from oversold levels
Gold-Oil Divergence	Unusual: both falling together previously (inflation + liquidity fear). Gold now decoupling upward as ceasefire risk-off fades.
MCX Outlook	Expect MCX gold to open sharply higher. Resistance near ■1,52,000/10g. Support at ■1,35,000.
Fed Impact	Rate hike fears = headwind for gold. But if US economy slows (payrolls -92K in Feb), gold finds support as recession hedge.
Advice	SIP in Gold ETFs / Sovereign Gold Bonds remains best retail strategy. Avoid lump sum at elevated levels; buy dips toward ■1,35,000/10g.

■ RUPEE & CURRENCY MARKETS

USD/INR (Current)	■93.76 — recovering from record ■93.98 hit Monday
Monthly Decline	Rupee dropped ~3% since Feb 28 (Iran war start)
FPI Outflows	>$11 billion in March — heaviest selling in 18 months; primary rupee pressure
RBI Intervention	Likely to defend ■94.50. Currently allowing market-driven adjustment.
Rupee vs Key Pairs	GBP/INR ~■124.9 | EUR/INR ~■101.4 | JPY/INR ~■0.617
Export Sector View	IT, Pharma, exporters benefit from weak rupee. Every ■1 fall vs USD = ~2–3% revenue boost for IT large-caps.
Import Sector View	Aviation (fuel costs in USD), Chemicals, Paint cos face margin headwind
DXY (Dollar Index)	~99.1 — easing as Iran talks progress; supports emerging market currencies

■ STARTUP & TECH FINANCE

■ FUNDING DEALS (Last 48 Hours)

Company	Round / Amount	Investors	Sector	Significance
Swish	$38M Series B	Hara Global, Bain Capital Ventures	Quick Commerce	One of the largest early-stage rounds this month
Metafin	$10M Debt	Lendable	Solar Fintech / Green Finance	Climate fintech capital active despite global uncertainty
Pranos	$6.8M Seed	Undisclosed	High-Field Fusion Reactors / DeepTech	India's deep-tech ambition in clean energy
Moneyview	IPO (DRHP filed)	SEBI Review	Digital Lending / Fintech	■1,500 Cr fresh issue; ■2,400 Cr revenue run-rate

■ AI & FINTECH INTEGRATION

Razorpay × Sarvam AI	Voice-first conversational commerce — AI agents completing payments via voice. India's first major AI-native payments stack.
India Deep Tech Alliance	Accel, Blume Ventures, Qualcomm Ventures, Nvidia (adviser) — backing India's ■1 trillion RDI Fund. Multi-year structural play.
AI in Banking	HDFC, ICICI exploring AI for credit underwriting and customer service. RBI monitoring AI-driven lending for systemic risk.
Crypto Markets	Bitcoin down ~11% YTD amid risk-off. Some seeing it as hedge vs currency debasement. Not mainstream institutional positioning yet.

■ ECOSYSTEM PULSE — 2026 YTD

Total Funding (2026 YTD)	$3.69 billion across 417 rounds — 29% decline vs same period 2025
Investor Mood	Cautious but selective. Fintech, Deep Tech, Climate Tech remain VC favourites
IPO Pipeline	Moneyview, + 5–6 other startups expected to file DRHPs in Q2 2026
Valuation Reset	Down-rounds or flat rounds more common in B2B SaaS; consumer tech re-valued

■ MARKET MOOD & KEY INDICATORS

INTRADAY RISK	OPPORTUNITY SECTOR	BIGGEST THREAT
MEDIUM–HIGH	**OIL & GAS / OMCs**	**Iran Talks Collapse**

■ OVERALL: CAUTIOUSLY BULLISH

Iran de-escalation has sparked a genuine relief rally — both globally and in India. However, Iranian officials have repeatedly contradicted US diplomatic claims. The Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed. This is a **relief bounce, not a confirmed trend reversal.**

Key sentiment drivers:

- ■ Iran peace plan sent by US — constructive
- ■ Crude oil -6% to $94 — India macro relief
- ■ VIX -6.82% — fear easing
- ■ FII selling ■1 lakh crore+ in March
- ■ Iran hasn't confirmed ceasefire
- ■ Fed may HIKE rates if oil re-spikes

KEY TECHNICAL LEVELS

NIFTY 50:

Support: 22,400 / 22,600

Resistance: 23,057 → 23,400 → 23,800

BANK NIFTY:

Range: 52,000–53,500

Breakout target: 56,000

SENSEX:

Support: 72,500 / 73,000

Resistance: 75,500 → 77,000

STRATEGY: Trade today with defined stop-losses. Headline risk is extreme.

■ SMART INVESTOR INSIGHT

■ SHORT-TERM ACTIONABLE INSIGHT

Crude fell from $115 → $94. OMC stocks (BPCL, HPCL, IOC) are the most direct beneficiary.

Every $5 fall in Brent crude = direct gross refining margin expansion for Indian OMCs.

Aviation stocks (IndiGo, Air India parent InterGlobe) also benefit — fuel is 30–40% of their cost.

Trade idea: Buy BPCL / IOC on any dip today with a stop below recent lows. Target a 5–8% move if crude stabilises below $90.

■■ Risk: Iran escalation headline can spike crude $8–10 instantly. Keep stop-losses TIGHT.

Market holiday tomorrow (Ram Navami) — carry overnight positions with caution.

■ LONG-TERM TREND OBSERVATION

India's Deep Tech Decade has officially begun.

The ■1 trillion RDI Fund, backed by Accel, Blume, Qualcomm, and Nvidia, signals a structural multi-year buildout in deep-tech.

Sectors to watch over 5–10 years: Semiconductor design, Space-tech (ISRO ecosystem), Defence electronics, AI infrastructure, and Green energy fintech.

Listed proxies: MTAR Technologies, Paras Defence, Data Patterns, KPIT Technologies.

SIP into a diversified Nifty 500 index fund + a small allocation to a tech/innovation thematic fund is the retail investor's best bet in this environment.

The current global volatility = an opportunity to accumulate quality at discounted prices.

■ THIS WEEK'S ECONOMIC CALENDAR

Date	Event	Impact	What to Watch
Wed Mar 25	India markets OPEN	HIGH	Gap-up open expected; sustain above 23,000?
Thu Mar 26	MARKET HOLIDAY (Ram Navami)	—	No trading. Positions carry weekend + holiday risk.
Fri Mar 27	India markets RE-OPEN	HIGH	Global Iran developments in 48 hrs = gap risk
Fri Mar 27	US PCE Inflation Data	VERY HIGH	Core PCE is Fed's preferred inflation gauge — market-moving
Apr 1, 2026	STT Hike on F&O Options	MEDIUM	Watch broking volumes and options OI shift pre-April
Apr 2026	RBI Monetary Policy	VERY HIGH	Rate cut possible if crude <$90 & CPI softens
Apr 2026	Q4 FY26 Results Season	HIGH	Banking, IT, FMCG earnings — key for re-rating

Data sourced from: CNBC, Goodreturns, 5paisa, NSE India, Euronews, Bloomberg, CNN Business, S&P Global, SEBI. All market data as of market close March 24, 2026 and pre-market cues March 25, 2026.